

ARIVAL360BRUCEROSARDEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, we are at the magnificent Arrival 360 event in Brisbane, and I have the co-founder here, Bruce Roszard. And Bruce, welcome to the program. Well, thank you, Geoffrey.

It's great to be here. Now, I've been attending this show for the last three days, and it's just a fantastic event because it's very intimate, it's very easy to connect with everybody. It's three or four hundred people here.

And unlike those huge shows, it's so much, I've found it so much better to connect with people personally here. It's a great show. And welcome to Australia.

Well, thanks. And really, it's not so much the size, but it's also what people do. Everyone here is in the destination experiences industry.

So most travel industry B2B events include hotels, airlines, DMOs. All we focus on is experiences, tours, activities, attractions. And that is what I think people appreciate the most.

I've noticed that, and it's concentrated. I mean, I go to shows like WTM in London, and you've got 50,000 people there of all different types of things. And it's very hard to track people down for an experiences thing.

And this is your first event here in Australia. And tell us about your future plans for Arrival 360. We've been doing these events for 10 years.

Started out in the US in 2017. And in 2019, we then went to Berlin, actually right before ITB that you just mentioned. And people love the fact that they could come to a smaller event, all about experiences, and then maybe spend a day at ITB.

And a lot of those people kind of never went back to ITB after seeing what we do. And also in 2019, we went to Bangkok. So by 2019, just a couple of years after we started, we were US, Europe, and APAC, which was great.

As far as future plans, we really love the event here in Australia. This is a great first year. I wouldn't quite say an experiment, but we wanted to make sure it would be successful.

And we've gotten phenomenal response. So we will be back in the region for sure. Whether it's Australia or back in a place like APAC, we will decide very, very soon.

But we'll be back in the region, definitely. And what's your background, Bruce? I know you're from Colorado and you were involved in the skiing industry and tourism there too. Right out of university, I started a ski travel company called Moguls Mountain Travel and did that for way too long, 23 years, but sold a lot of ski trips for groups and as well as FIT.

A website built in 1995 and so basically discovered online travel at that point. After selling that company three times, we don't have enough time to talk about why I sold the same company three times, Jeffrey, but did, and then went to work at a company called Focusrite, which does events and research for the overall global travel industry, focused on tech and innovation. Did that for about eight years, learned a lot from the then founder and CEO, Philip Wolf, helped him sell that company, and then started arrival with my co-founder Douglas Quimby in 2017, who I met at Focusrite.

Now this event, it's been tremendous for the interactions between the experiences operators here and the feedback I've been getting from all the operators is 110% positive. You must be very happy with the kind of relationships that are forming during this conference. That's the key of Arrival, right? We spend a lot of time putting together content and the content was really well received.

The theater that we have, we call it the Arrival Theater, was full the whole time, which often in our US event and our European event, a lot of people aren't in the theater because they're networking and doing business. At this event, they were in the theater almost the whole time and the networking lounge was less busy, except for when we create what we call white space, our coffee breaks and our lunch breaks. You want to make sure that the sponsors get to meet all the people and all the sponsors were happy as well, so we're super excited about that.

No matter how good the content is, and it was good and we got great response to it, the best part of the learning is the peer-to-peer learning. So it's the operators who run these experiences, who learn from each other. It's not competitive.

They don't feel like, oh, I have secrets I don't want to share. That peer-to-peer learning is really pretty much our secret sauce at Arrival. And you have this fabulous lunch here where you have big tables to hold up to about 10 people.

I sat in on two of the lunches and just the off-the-cuff meetings of people, just having lunch with people they've never met before. Oh, what do you do? I do this. Oh, wow, we could use that.

So social events you have are very important. Well, absolutely. I mean, the lunches definitely create some of that, but so did the pub crawl last night.

We went to three different pubs where we had drink tickets we gave people and we said, just go to these three pubs. At midnight last night, there was a lot of that same learning going on from each other, people just sharing what they do. And so it's a different kind of socialization happening.

Yeah. Now the next event coming up. Somewhere in the region, whether it's in Australia or APAC, yes, for sure.

And how can people find out more, Bruce, about Arrival 360 online? Arrival.travel. Arrival always only has one R. So as long as you remember that, although I'm sure if you do a Google search or a chat GPT search looking for Arrival conference about travel, you'll find it that way. But Arrival.travel will tell you everything you need to know. Great.

So if you are a tour operator or an experienced operator in the industry here in Australia or anywhere in the world, check out the Arrival conferences. And thank you very much, Bruce Rozard, for being part of the program. Thank you, Geoffrey.